



Vladislav Laikov

Senior PHP Developer

Symfony / Laravel · distributed systems & high load

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Remote · UTC+3

Senior backend engineer, **7+ years on PHP / Symfony**. For the last **3.5 years** my home ground has been the **money path of a product**: payments, balances and integrations; **12+ payment providers** shipped to production.

My strengths are:

- **Payment idempotency**. I design so a payment cannot be lost, duplicated or spent twice: uniqueness enforced by the database, lock ordering instead of retries layered over the symptom, internal and external states that never diverge
- **Change on live production without a maintenance window**. Major database and framework upgrades, a dialect switch, carving services out of a monolith — staged and reversible, on a **~50 TB** cluster and a **2 TB+** production database
- **Infrastructure is not someone else's job**. **Docker** and **Kubernetes**, **RabbitMQ** and **Kafka**, replication and sharding, **GitLab CI** / **GitHub Actions** pipelines, alerting in **Grafana** — I carry an epic from the architectural decision to the graphs in production

PROFILE

CORE COMPETENCIES: payment integrations and billing · PHP / Symfony · Laravel · PostgreSQL · high-load and distributed systems

DOMAINS: **payments & billing** · **fintech core** · SaaS · MedTech · classifieds · outsourcing

SKILLS

Languages & frameworks: PHP 5.6—8.4, **Symfony 3.4—7.4**, **Laravel 6—13**, Doctrine, API Platform, Symfony Messenger, **Go**, Composer / PSR, **OOP**, **SOLID** · GRASP, GoF patterns, DDD, CQRS, Hexagonal

Data & database performance: **PostgreSQL 14—18**, MySQL 5.7—8, **Redis**, **MongoDB**, **ClickHouse**, Elasticsearch, PgBouncer · query plans and composite indexes, partitioning of growing tables, sharding, logical replication, upgrades under load

Infrastructure & operations: **Docker**, **Kubernetes**, **Linux**, **AWS** (ECS, EC2, S3), Nginx, **GitLab CI**, GitHub Actions, **Grafana** / **Loki**, Prometheus, Sentry, ELK · metrics, logs, alerting, incident analysis down to root cause

Distributed systems & real-time: **Kafka**, **RabbitMQ**, Symfony Messenger, **Mercure**, **Centrifugo**, WebSocket, microservices, REST API / OpenAPI · webhook intake and orchestration, idempotent handlers, retries and DLQ, outbox, saga

Quality & testing: **PHPUnit**, **PHPStan** (level 9), Rector, CS Fixer, GrumPHP, deprac · code review, staged legacy refactoring without rewrites, tests against real databases

EXPERIENCE

Apr 2024 — Jun 2026

Senior PHP Developer · payments team

systeme.io — international SaaS platform · Remote

Funnels, courses, email marketing, payment acceptance. **Payments team** — the domain where a mistake costs money directly: **~50 TB** of data, **12+ providers**, microservices around a monolith.

Stack: PHP 8.3—8.5, **Symfony 6.4—7.4**, Doctrine, **PostgreSQL 14—18**, **MongoDB**, **Redis**, **RabbitMQ**, **Kafka**, **Docker**, **AWS**, **Grafana** / **Loki**, **PHPStan** level 9, GrumPHP

- Ran a major **PostgreSQL 14 → 18** upgrade on a **~50 TB** cluster without pausing payment acceptance: logical replication, drift driven to zero before cut-over, one contour switched at a time with the option to step back at any point.
- Owned **all 12+ payment integrations** on the platform. Delivered **Apple Pay via Stripe** end-to-end and extracted one provider **from the monolith into a standalone microservice** — its own database, its own deployment, a shared contract bundle: a new provider plugs in without touching the core.
- Designed a **partial-refund engine**: the business gave a one-line requirement — I defined the granularity (order-item level), four webhook routing scenarios, a guarded status machine and over-refund protection.
- Built payment webhook intake so that **no money event is ever dropped or applied twice**: the raw payload is stored before processing, a guard on the event key, signature verification, retries over 30 days, and a bypass path during database maintenance.
- With the team, **cut hot-path query latency 3x**: profiling, indexing strategies, batch processing in **Doctrine**. Owned the epic end-to-end — design, splitting work across two developers, acceptance.
- Ran **PHP 8.3 → 8.5** and **Symfony 6.4 → 7.4 LTS** migrations on live production. Discipline through tooling: **PHPStan level 9**, a hard CI gate on every PR, real PostgreSQL and Redis in tests instead of mocks.

Mar 2023 — Mar 2024

PHP Developer · CORE team

Octopays (Mservis) — fintech platform · Remote

Payment transaction processing and card payouts. Core team, **2 TB+** production database, real-time transaction processing, event-driven architecture.

Stack: PHP 7.4—8.2, Laravel 9—10, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Kafka, Docker, ELK, PHPUnit, PHPStan

- Balances with an **in-flight reserve**: money promised to pending operations cannot be spent twice under parallel requests. Payout idempotency enforced by a **unique database index** — the database rejects the duplicate, not the application code.
- Eliminated **deadlocks** on parallel balance recalculation through **lock ordering and targeted FOR UPDATE** under READ COMMITTED — prevention at the access-pattern level, not a retry wrapper over the symptom.
- Financial module: a transaction moves through about ten internal statuses while the merchant sees a simple pending / success / fail — built so that internal and external state never diverge.
- Took part in the **MySQL → PostgreSQL** switch on a critical contour: reworking the schema for PG-specific types and indexes, staged data migration with no loss of integrity, aligning legacy code with the new dialect, and validation in production.
- **Laravel 9 → 10** migration, refactoring of critical payment pipelines, test coverage (**PHPUnit**), static analysis (**PHPStan**), observability on **ELK**.

Apr 2020 — Mar 2023

PHP Developer

Basis33 — outsourcing for EU clients · Remote

A team of **25 engineers**. I ran two products in unrelated domains, both shipped to production: a **German medical platform** — two years, strict compliance, appointment booking and calendars — and a **video consultation service** integrated with the Zoom API.

Stack: PHP 7.4, Symfony 5.3, API Platform, MySQL, RabbitMQ, Redis, Docker, GitLab CI/CD

- Sped up the heavy screens of the medical platform: pulled query plans, unfolded **N+1** into explicit joins, picked composite indexes matching the real filters, moved hot result sets into **Redis** with invalidation driven by domain events. The production cluster ran with **replication and partitioning** — read paths went to the replica.
- Kept contracts aligned between Frontend, Backend and DevOps: on a medical platform a mismatched contract costs more than a bug in the code.
- Two unfamiliar domains back to back, both taken to production: stepping into someone else's problem space is routine for me, not an exception.

Feb 2019 — Mar 2020

PHP Developer

Sollento Group — classifieds and data collection · Remote

Search-driven SPA classifieds platform and an automated data collection service.

Stack: PHP, Symfony, Doctrine, PostgreSQL, Docker, Swagger, GitLab CI

- Built the backend of a classifieds platform: a domain model shaped for search and filtering in **PostgreSQL**, a versioned **REST contract** documented in Swagger, automated builds and deployment through **GitLab CI**. The first place where I owned a system rather than individual tickets.
- Wrote a collector pulling listings from external sources to keep the catalogue populated; laid out the codebase as **SOA** following SOLID and GRASP.

BEYOND WORK

- I run my own products from idea and architecture through to production deployment, with no team behind me: a community platform on **DDD / CQRS** with context boundaries enforced by **deptrac**, an EdTech platform executing code in the browser with real-time collaboration, and a travel marketplace with **Go** microservices. Frontend and mobile — Vue 3, Next.js, React Native.
- **I mentor PHP developers from mid to senior**: concept maps, code review, mock interviews, weak-spot tracking; AI-assisted spec → code → QA loops are part of the process.

EDUCATION

Minsk, Belarus

Belarusian State University of Informatics and Radioelectronics

Faculty of Computer Systems and Networks — Computer Science

English — **B1** · Portfolio with projects, metrics and stack — vladis-dev-skill.github.io/cv

